

Artificial light

Sprawling cities across the East Coast at night are clearly visible in this photograph taken by astronauts aboard the International Space Station (ISS).

Long Island and New York can be seen on the right, Philadelphia, Pittsburgh, and other major cities in the center. Streetlights and lights in homes and gardens contribute to the glow. For people on the ground, some of the light is reflected back by a haze of dust and water vapor, creating light pollution that makes it hard to see the stars in the night sky.

